JAMESCLEMENT ONYEKACHI UGWU

Climate and Agricultural Productivity | Agricultural Economics | Food Security | Precision Agriculture
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE:

I am an early-career interdisciplinary researcher in agricultural economics and food security, studying how climate-related shocks affect agricultural productivity, and how precision agriculture and sustainable food production can help eradicate poverty in low-resource settings. I led, as Principal Investigator, an ICERP-funded market-pilot study of household preferences and adoption of chicken-cow compost for urban and peri-urban backyard cultivation in Abuja (2025–2026), now available as an SSRN preprint. My earlier work includes an auto-regressive distributed lag (ARDL) model analysis of climate change and agricultural productivity, and a published, peer-reviewed longitudinal study of household living conditions and food insecurity in Nigeria during COVID-19. My focus areas are climate-smart and precision agriculture, rural development, and food systems that are productive, equitable and sustainable. My conviction is simple: 'Nobody deserves to be poor and underfed'.

Research Philosophy: I believe that rigorous research should extend beyond academic publication to strengthen institutions, foster transparency and accountability, improve lives, and advance sustainable development. Hence, my work is guided by RETIRE, a self-developed framework prioritizing Rigorous, Evidence-driven, Transparent, Impact-Oriented, Reproducible, and Ethically responsible research. The framework aligns with UNESCO's open science principles to guarantee robust and universally accessible scientific outcomes.

EDUCATION

SOUTH DAKOTA STATE UNIVERSITY (SDSU). **Brookings, USA.**
Programme: *Masters of Sciences (M.Sc.), Economics.* (admitted 2025; entry deferred).
Specialization: General Economics (major).
Minors: Health, and Econometrics.

Research Assistantship Award Recipient

- Admitted to the M.Sc. Economics programme
- Awarded a competitive Research Assistantship
- Programme Start deferred

UNIVERSITY OF NIGERIA, NSUKKA (UNN). **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Programme: *Bachelor of Sciences (B.Sc.), Economics.* (2016-2020-21).
Qualification/Honours: *Upper Second (Magna cum Laude)* June 2021.
Selected Coursework: Mathematical Economics, Statistics, Applied Statistics & Econometrics, Advanced Statistics & Econometrics, Computing Applications for Economists, Business Finance, Business mgmt. Accounting, Research Methods & Development Economics.

RESEARCH PROFILE

Research Scope (HAF)

- **Agricultural Economics**
  a) Precision Agriculture b) Food Security c) Agricultural Productivity d) Climate-Smart Agriculture e) Rural Development

Methodological Interests and Expertise, Quantitative Skills & Computational Databases

- **Econometrics**
  a) Linear Regression (OLS, ARDL, Time-Series, Cross-Sectional, and Panel-Data) Analysis. b) Logistic Regression Analysis (Binary, Ordered, and Multinomial Logit) models. c) Probit and Tobit models. d) Duration Models (Count Model analysis, Negative Binomial estimation, and Survival Analysis.
- **Evidence Synthesis**
  a) Systematic Reviews b) Meta-Analysis c) Scoping Reviews d) Bibliographical and Scientometric Analysis e) Prisma and Frameworks Reporting.
- **Statistical Inference and Predictive Analytics**
  a) Parametric and non-parametric testing (t-tests, ANOVA, Chi-Square, Mann-Whitney tests) b) SOTA trend/stationarity tests (Augmented Dickey Fuller; ADF, Mann-Kendall, KPSS) tests.
- **Survey and Data Collection Tools**
  a) Online survey forms (Survey Monkeys, Google Forms, Microsoft Forms) b) Enterprise Survey Platforms (Qualtrics XM, LimeSurvey, SurveyCTO, Open Data Kit (ODK), and Kobo Toolbox.
- **Computational Database, Statistics & Financial Toolkits**
  a) Programming (SQL; for relational database queries, R, and Python. b) Statistical Platforms (Stata, E-views, and SPSS c) Research Platforms and Registries (PACTR, Zenodo, PROSPERO, Zotero, SSRN, Rayyan, and OSF; Open Science Framework).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE AND INNOVATION PROJECTS

B. Collaborative Grants & Funded Research Projects.

1. Household Food Production and preference Analysis of WTBS Chicken-Cow Compost for Urban and Peri-Urban Backyard Cultivation. Aug 2025 – June 2026.
Principal Investigator | Independent Research Project (ICERP) |Market-Pilot Research **Abuja, Nigeria.**

- Funded $4,000 (US dollar) research by ICERP (own organization) for a market pilot study examining household preferences, adoption behaviour, and supply-chain dynamics of chicken-cow compost utilization.
- Designed the research methodology, reviewed literature and developed a working paper/preprint available through SSRN.

Methods: Survey Research | Preference Analysis |Applied Econometrics (SEM & Ordered Logistic Regression)

RESEARCH OUTPUTS AND SCHORLARLY CONTRIBUTIONS

Peer-reviewed Publications.

1. **British Medical Journal (BMJ):** *Household Living Conditions and Food Insecurity in Nigeria: A Longitudinal Study During Covid-19 Pandemic* (2022) – https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2022-066810

B.Sc. Dissertation |Open Source (Available on Academia & ResearchGate)

2. Climate change and Agricultural Productivity Nexus: An ARDL (Autoregressive Distributed Lag Model) Approach. | Available on: https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.15361.33121 | *Also Available on Academia Database*

WORK AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ICERP (Independent Centre for Experiments, Research, and Programmes) **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Founder/Lead Researcher. March 2023 – Present

- Guided 30+ M.Sc. and Ph.D. students on research conceptualization and methodology design, working with researchers and scholars of varying ranks across academic institutions.
- Led a small team of young scholars constituting the not-for-profit small-scale think tank, offering independent research services and grant proposals writing for solving public health and socio-economic issues.

Freelance Remote Gigs (Fiverr, Mercor, and Mindrift) **Remote, Worldwide.**
Annotation and RLHF Specialist (AI-trainer) August 2024 – Present

- *RLHF and Model Tuning:* Specialized in Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF) through reward model training.
- *Advanced Annotation*: Expertise in complex Data Labelling, Prompt Engineering, and creating comprehensive Evaluation Rubrics for model alignment.

National Accounts, Energy and Environmental Statistics Division (NAESSD),
National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Graduate Special Assistant to Chief Economist & National Youth Service Corp (NYSC) Nov. 2021 – Feb. 2023.

- Successfully collated the statutory allocation and internally generated revenue of states in Nigeria.
- Successfully contributed to the retrieval of institutional periodic data from public parastatals in Abuja.
- Collaborated and partook in data outsourcing, surveys, and field trips to different states for data collection.

PARG, (Policy Analysis and Research Group) UNN **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Director of Research and Academic Planning (DRAP; elected) July 2019- August 2021

- Organized annual parliamentary policy debate, developed, and managed PARG's E-library and media repository.
- Mentored enthusiastic analysts, organized intra-university field trip,
- Successfully directed over 40 research projects and their subsequent official presentations.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Catholic Lectors Association of Nigeria *(CLAN),* Catholic Secretariat of Nigeria (CSN). **F.C.T, Abuja Nigeria.**
Chairman, Byelaw-Drafting Committee. May 2024 – August 2025.

- Led a 5-man committee inclusive of lawyers to draft a byelaw for the association.

*Chairman, **INEC (Independent NESA Electoral Commission).*** June 2021 – August 2021.

- Successfully superintended the conducting of credible election & transition of Govt. **Enugu-State, Nigeria**

*Secretary | President, **Students Board of Lectors (SBL), UNN**.* April 2018 | May 2019 – Aug. 2021.

- Successfully developed 10 years reading directory and edited a maiden reading guide.
- Increased the board's annual revenue by 63% through strategic introduction of utility pamphlets and programmes.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Happy End Academy, Odim Gate, UNN. **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Pre-College Tutor [Economics, English Language]. March 2017 – July, 2021.
• Consistently improved the performances of over 65% of students in their external tests.
*Team Lead, **Academic Tutorials, UNN.*** April 2017 – June 2021, **Enugu, Nigeria.**

- Personally reviewed, summarized and developed revision questions from 7 General Studies' (GS) courses for all students of UNN.
- Led a 4-man team that periodically organize and teach in Revision classes and tutorials for school mates [**Applied Computing to Economics, Econometrics, Advanced Statistics, & Intermediate Micro & Macro Economics]**
- Successfully organized and mobilized funds for fees and tuitions of indigent and bereaved course mates.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

- **Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH)** **London, UK.**
- **Policy Analysis and Research Group** *(PARG Senior-ranking member)* **Nigeria**
- **Data Science Nigeria (DSN)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Statistical Association (NSA)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Economic Society (NES)** - **Nigeria**

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS, AND EVENTS.

- **RSTMH Global Research in Progress Webinar, (Colloquium).** **Virtual, June 2025.**
- **Delegate, National Youth Confab.** October 7 – 8, 2026.
- **RSTMH Annual General Meeting & Grants Workshop.** **London, United Kingdom**.
  Equitable partnerships in Global Health October 15 – 17, 2026.
- **CFA Institute Webinar:** Harnessing AI for smarter Investment Decisions. Apr 24, 2025.

SKILLS, INTERESTS, AND AWARDS

Other soft skills: Leadership, Critical Thinking, Human management, Emotional Intelligence, Negotiation skills, Communication skills, Analytical and business skills, Logic & Philosophy, Script Writing, and Sales.
Interests: • Entrepreneurship • Football, • Travelling • Artificial Intelligence (AI) Creation • Social Media • Music and • News.
Merit Awards:
• Best Researcher [Policy Analysis and Research Group - 2021]. • Most Resourceful member [PARG – 2021]
• Leadership Excellence [PARG, 2021]. • Excellence for Selfless Service [UNN, 2021]
• Leadership Excellence [SBL, 2021]. • Best Policy Debater [PARG & NESA, 2018-2020] and More.

REFEREES

Available on Request.